

Mark 1:29–34

“Jesus Who Enters the House”

July 12, 2026

Today also, let us continue reading through the Gospel of Mark.

Last time, we saw that in the synagogue at Capernaum, Jesus taught as one who had authority, and cast out an unclean spirit.

Today’s passage is the continuation of that. It is not the story of a different day, but an event occurring on the afternoon and into the evening of that same single day.

In other words, chapter 1, verses 21 through 34, describe the events of one unbroken day.

And within this one day, the scene moves.

- From the synagogue, a public place, to the house, a place of daily life.
- From the dramatic event of casting out a demon, to the quiet event of healing a fever.
- From a single person to the people of the whole town.

Today, while tracing this movement, I would like us to see where it is that Jesus goes.

Mark 1:29 *And immediately he left the synagogue and entered the house of Simon and Andrew, with James and John.*

Here again, we have the word “immediately.”

“Immediately” = the Greek word “eutheos” (εὐθύς). It appears about 40 times in Mark, 11 times in chapter 1 alone. It is a characteristic word of Mark’s, expressing the urgency produced by the nearness of the kingdom of God.

Before the lingering astonishment from the synagogue had even cooled, Jesus moved on to the next place. That destination is today’s major point.

Where did Jesus go after leaving the synagogue? It was not to a larger assembly hall. It was not to the temple in Jerusalem. It was to the “house” of Simon and Andrew. In other words, he went into a home. This is the point.

And who was there? Simon and Andrew, James and John. All four men who were called in chapter 1, verses 16 through 20. (At this point, not yet “disciples.”)

Now, let us recall. What did Jesus say to them? “Follow me” (1:17).

Then, where was it that they, having obeyed that call, were led to next after the synagogue?

After showing a sign that astonished the people, the place they went to was not a larger venue, but a very private space, a “house” — this is a very major point.

The place they were to follow him to was not a pious, religious place, nor a stage of authoritative politics, but simply their own ordinary home in which they lived.

We tend to picture some special, holy place when we speak of following Jesus.

However, the walk of “following” that Scripture depicts was entering one’s own house.

From the very beginning, the gospel enters not the house of a saint, but an ordinary house.

In fact, in the Gospel of Mark, after this the “house” repeatedly becomes the stage for Jesus’ work.

Mark 2:1 *And when he returned to Capernaum after some days, it was reported that he was at home.*

Mark 2:15 *And as he reclined at table in his house, many tax collectors and sinners were reclining with Jesus and his disciples, for there were many who followed him.*

Mark 9:33 *And they came to Capernaum. And when he was in the house he asked them, “What were you discussing on the way?”*

Mark 10:10 *And in the house the disciples asked him again about this matter.*

In this way, Jesus teaches his disciples important things inside the house.

In other words, in Mark, the house is a place of teaching and healing that stands alongside the synagogue — no, that is even more everyday than the synagogue. In other words, the home is “a place where the power of God is richly manifested.”

And this is also proof that Jesus is one who is deeply involved in our daily life, in life itself.

Mark 1:30 *Now Simon’s mother-in-law lay ill with a fever, and immediately they told him about her.*

This “at once” is “immediately.” It is the ninth occurrence within chapter 1.

Now, in this house there was a problem. Simon’s mother-in-law was lying ill with a fever.

“Lay” = in Greek, the imperfect tense. Not temporary, but a continuous state of “having been lying ill all along.”

In other words, her illness was not one that would soon cause death, but the suffering was intense.

And this day was the Sabbath. On the Sabbath, “treating” an illness that was not life-threatening was forbidden.

Later Jewish regulations spelled this out specifically.

Calling a doctor was not permitted, nor was compounding medicine.

Rubbing in vinegar or wine, the standard treatment for fever, was explicitly forbidden by name.

Since one could not build a fire, making anything warm was also forbidden. Even wetting and wringing out a cloth was considered to constitute “laundering.”

In other words, they could not even change a single towel on her forehead.

So then, what did the people of this house do? “They told him about her.”

They only told him — they did not instruct him on a prescription, nor did they demand healing. They simply spoke to Jesus about her.

And Jesus, responding to this, healed this mother-in-law.

Here is the prototype of prayer. It was not that they had a fine vocabulary of prayer. “Lord, this is the

situation.” That alone constitutes prayer.

And the important point here is that “simply telling” leads to “entrusting.”

It is not pressing upon God with a human intention of “please do such-and-such,” but that when we simply entrust it to him, God does what is best.

What the Lord does when we “tell” him in this way is expressed in the next passage.

Mark 1:31 *And he came and took her by the hand and lifted her up, and the fever left her, and she began to serve them.*

First, he “comes near.”

Certainly, Jesus is one who is able to heal even from a distance, by word alone (the centurion’s servant in Matthew 8). But here, he walked over to the very bedside.

Next, he “took her by the hand.”

“Take by the hand” = the Greek word “krateo” (κρατέω). “To grasp firmly.”

In Mark, this action appears repeatedly at the decisive moment of healing.

Mark 5:41 *Taking her by the hand he said to her, “Talitha cumi,” which means, “Little girl, I say to you, arise.”*

Mark 5:42 *And immediately the girl got up and began walking (for she was twelve years of age), and they were immediately overcome with amazement.*

Mark 9:26 *And after crying out and convulsing him terribly, it came out, and the boy was like a corpse, so that most of them said, “He is dead.”*

Mark 9:27 *But Jesus took him by the hand and lifted him up, and he arose.*

In both cases, “taking by the hand” and “raising up” appear as a pair.

In fact, this scene has an Old Testament type.

1 Kings 17:18 *And she said to Elijah, “What have you against me, O man of God? You have come to me to bring my sin to remembrance and to cause the death of my son!”*

1 Kings 17:19 *And he said to her, “Give me your son.” And he took him from her arms and carried him up into the upper chamber where he lodged, and laid him on his own bed.*

1 Kings 17:20 *And he cried to the LORD, “O LORD my God, have you brought calamity even upon the widow with whom I sojourn, by killing her son?”*

1 Kings 17:21 *Then he stretched himself upon the child three times and cried to the LORD, “O LORD my God, let this child’s life come into him again.”*

1 Kings 17:22 *And the LORD listened to the voice of Elijah, and the life of the child came into him again, and he revived.*

2 Kings 4:32 *When Elisha came into the house, he saw the child lying dead on his bed.*

2 Kings 4:33 *So he went in and shut the door behind the two of them and prayed to the LORD.*

2 Kings 4:34 *Then he went up and lay on the child, putting his mouth on his mouth, his eyes on his eyes, and his hands on his hands. And as he stretched himself upon him, the flesh of the child*

became warm.

2 Kings 4:35 *Then he got up again and walked once back and forth in the house, and went up and stretched himself upon him. The child sneezed seven times, and the child opened his eyes.*

Elisha also raised the child of the Shunammite woman to life, inside a house (2 Kings 4).

A prophet enters a house, and the one lying down is raised up. Today's passage stands upon this type.

However, there is a decisive difference. Both Elijah and Elisha went through the labor of praying, prostrating themselves, and repeating the act. Jesus merely took her by the hand.

Here we can say that the difference between "prophets" — that is, the servants of God — and the Master, is made manifest.

And, "lifted her up."

"Raise/lift up" = the Greek word "egeiro" (ἐγείρω).

Where does this word appear at the end of the Gospel of Mark? Chapter 16, verse 6. At the empty tomb, the angel declares, "He has risen (ēgerthē)."

The word "raise" that Mark uses for healing is the same verb used to speak of the resurrection. What happened on the bed in Peter's house can be said to be a foretaste of what would happen in Joseph's tomb.

In other words, the reader of Mark is given a clue toward understanding Jesus' resurrection every time Jesus takes someone's hand and raises them up.

And it says "the fever left her," but in the original it reads "the fever went away from her."

The fever, as though it were an occupier that had taken up residence, "departs" from the person. Healing is depicted as liberation from a hostile thing.

And finally, the greatest point of this verse: "she began to serve them."

"Serve" = the Greek word "diakoneo" (διακονέω). "To serve." The origin of the word "deacon."

Why is this an important point?

This word "serve" appears only four times in the Gospel of Mark. Let us line up those four occurrences.

Chapter 1, verse 13. In the wilderness, the angels were "ministering" to Jesus.

Chapter 1, verse 31. Peter's mother-in-law "served" them. → Today's passage.

Chapter 10, verse 45. "For even the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many."

Chapter 15, verse 41. The women who watched over the cross. "When he was in Galilee, they followed him and ministered to him."

In other words, in the Gospel of Mark, the ones who become the subject of this word are only the angels, this woman who was healed, the women from Galilee onward (who would become the first witnesses of the resurrection), and Jesus himself.

The twelve disciples never once become the subject of this verb. In other words, they did not serve at

this level. Rather, they desired to “become great” — that is, they wished to be served.

Mark 9:33 *And they came to Capernaum. And when he was in the house he asked them, “What were you discussing on the way?”*

Mark 9:34 *But they kept silent, for on the way they had argued with one another about who was the greatest.*

Mark 9:35 *And he sat down and called the twelve. And he said to them, “If anyone would be first, he must be last of all and servant of all.”*

In other words, Peter’s mother-in-law is the person who first embodied the way of life of Jesus that the disciples were unable to do.

Mark 10:44 *and whoever would be first among you must be slave of all.*

Mark 10:45 *For even the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many.*

Some read this as, “Wasn’t the healed woman, after all, simply put back to kitchen work?” However, Scripture says the exact opposite.

Scripture wrote of her act using the same word as the angels’ ministry and as the Son of Man giving his life.

In the value system of Scripture, serving is not “menial labor.” It is the very definition of great work.

She left no name in this passage. But this verb proves the rightness of her existence.

And here, we should pay attention to the order.

It was not that she was healed once she became able to serve. One who could do nothing, who was simply lying ill, first had her hand taken unilaterally and was raised up. Serving came after that.

Raised up first, and then serving. This order is the gospel.

We sometimes, before we know it, invert this order. We work in order to be accepted by God. We keep on serving in order to be raised up.

That can be called a religiosity in which the order is inverted, a misreading of faith. The gospel always begins from the point of “being raised up first.”

Mark 1:32 *That evening at sundown they brought to him all who were sick or oppressed by demons.*

Mark 1:33 *And the whole city was gathered together at the door.*

“That evening at sundown.” The expression of time is doubled. This is a sign that Mark is emphasizing this point.

Why sundown? Because this day was the Sabbath. The Sabbath ends at sundown.

In other words, the people of the town were waiting for the sun to set.

The rumor of what happened at the synagogue had already spread throughout the whole town (1:28).

But during the Sabbath, they could not carry the sick. So the moment the last light faded, the whole town began to move all at once.

“Brought” is in the imperfect tense: “they kept carrying them one after another.” Not a single procession, but an unbroken stream.

And verse 33: “the whole city was gathered together at the door.”

What should be noted here is that the word “gathered” shares the same root as “synagogue.”

That morning, the place where the people gathered was the synagogue. That night, the place where the whole town gathered was the doorway of a single house.

Here there is an image of the center of worship having moved — from the building to the place where Jesus is. The place where Jesus is becomes the place where people ought to gather.

Mark 1:34 *And he healed many who were sick with various diseases, and cast out many demons. And he would not permit the demons to speak, because they knew him.*

That night, Jesus healed many people and cast out many demons.

Mark carefully distinguishes between the sick and those possessed by demons in his writing, so the interpretation that illness is “always the fault of demons” does not hold.

And the same thing that happened last time happens here again. Jesus “did not permit” the demons “to speak.”

The demons’ knowledge was accurate. As we saw last time. But Jesus does not let them speak. This is to prevent knowledge alone from taking on a life of its own.

Until the cross reveals the true meaning of the word “Messiah,” Jesus continues to issue “commands of silence.”

Application

The authority of Jesus that was spoken of in the synagogue was not something belonging to the synagogue alone. He leaves the synagogue and enters a single house. In other words, that authority extends into daily life.

Here is something we ought to remember today.

At that time, after the service of worship ended, where did Jesus go? To Simon’s house.

Then, after today’s service of worship ends, where will Jesus go? We need to consider this.

Are we not leaving our faith behind at church when we go home?

The Sunday synagogue and the weekday home are not, to Jesus, separate jurisdictions. Jesus is the one who comes from the synagogue into our homes.

Into our homes, into our lives, into our Monday dinner table, Jesus is about to enter. We must not forget to hold this awareness.

He is always with us. In good times and in bad, the Lord is with us. Even in the moment when we betrayed that Lord with all our strength, the Lord was with us.

And one more thing. That night, the people of the whole town gathered at the doorway. But as we read

on through the Gospel of Mark, this crowd eventually fades away.

What remained beside the cross were only the few who had “ministered to him in Galilee” (15:41).

The crowd gathered at the doorway, and the one whose hand was taken inside the house. Which of the two are we here as?

As a guest standing in the procession line for grace? Or as one who has been raised up and serves?

We Christians often use the phrase “to live like Jesus.” The Gospel of Mark clearly defines what that means.

It means to live by serving. “For even the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve” (10:45).

And the first model of this was not someone who stood in a pulpit, nor someone who went out on a missionary journey, but one nameless woman who, with the very hand that had been raised up, served a meal to the people in front of her.

However, do not forget the order. First, we are raised up.

Diligence that skips over having one’s hand taken becomes, before we know it, a bed that lays us low in place of the fever. Let us first have our hand taken. Serving comes after that.

And here is something important. Serving after being raised up means, in other words, understanding that serving itself is joy.

It means being able to feel the joy of spending one’s time for the one we love, the happiness of being able to put our strength to use. Serving, including this, is what is being carried out.

Finally, let us look at where this table of service is heading, and bring this to a close.

Luke 12:37 *Blessed are those servants whom the master finds awake when he comes. Truly, I say to you, he will dress himself for service and have them recline at table, and he will come and serve them.*

On the last day, Jesus, who is the master, will gird himself and serve us.

On that day, the woman who was healed served a meal to Jesus. On the last day, Jesus will have us, who have been redeemed, recline at the table, and will himself serve us.

The story of our service does not end with “I served the Lord.” It ends at the table where the Lord serves us.

If serving is love, then this means receiving a wonderful love.

And the story of “Jesus who enters the house” also has a destination it arrives at.

John 14:23 *Jesus answered him, “If anyone loves me, he will keep my word, and my Father will love him, and we will come to him and make our home with him.”*

On that one day in Capernaum, Jesus entered Simon’s house. And now, Jesus, together with the Father, promises to come to us and to live together with us.

It is not a visit. It is cohabitation. It means living together as a family that loves one another.

So that we may arrive at this conclusion, Jesus now desires to enter our house.

He is the one who first enters into the very center of our lives, into the room we least want to show anyone.

And he is the one who takes the hand of the one lying ill, raises them up, and drives out whatever has taken up residence like a fever.

This week, let us welcome this one into our house. Let us have our hand taken, and be raised up. And as those who have been raised up, let us serve the one person in front of us.

Let us walk into this new week, looking forward in hope to the grace of that Lord Jesus Christ, who, filled with love and joy, gave his own life in order to raise us up.